NEWSLETTER

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Department of Computer Science And Applications
Panjab University , Chandigarh

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Lohri Celebration 2026: Embracing Tradition and Togetherness



Lohri, the first festival of the year, symbolizes new beginnings, hope, and prosperity. Continuing this cherished tradition, it was celebrated on January 13, 2026 with great enthusiasm and festive spirit at DCSA.

The celebration witnessed the gracious presence of the faculty, technical staff and office staff members of both Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam Computer Centre and DCSA. The event commenced with the lighting of the ceremonial bonfire by Prof. (Dr.) Sonal Chawla, Director of Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam Computer Centre, along with Dr. Anuj Sharma, Chairperson, DCSA. Gathered around the bonfire, faculty and staff offered prayers and heartfelt wishes for a year filled with happiness, prosperity, and good health.

Adding vibrancy to the occasion, the students uplifted the atmosphere with energetic dhol beats and joyful dance, encouraging everyone to join in the festivities. The teaching and non-teaching staff enthusiastically joined the students, dancing together around the bonfire and strengthening the spirit of unity and celebration. Traditional Lohri savouries including moongfali, rewri, gajak, and til patti were shared among all, enhancing the warmth of togetherness and festivity.

The event concluded on a cheerful note, with everyone exchanging good wishes and smiles, carrying forward the spirit of unity and optimism. The Lohri celebration truly reflected a harmonious blend of tradition, joy, and community, setting a positive tone for the year ahead.

– Rishabh Bhatia MSC-I

Honouring a Legacy of Excellence and Leadership : Professor R. K. Singla





The Department of Computer Science and Applications (DCSA), Panjab University, bid a heartfelt farewell to Professor R. K. Singla, recognizing his distinguished service to the University spanning more than three decades.
Professor Singla began his association with Panjab University more than three decades ago and went on to make enduring contributions to teaching, research, and institutional development. Over the course of his distinguished career, he held several key academic and administrative positions, including serving as Chairperson of DCSA, leading major institutional committees, acting as Advisor for CIIPP, Coordinator for ICOSER, Chairperson of the NAAC Steering Committee, Dean Research, and Dean University Instructions, Director at Dr. A. P. J. Abdul Kalam Computer Center, playing a pivotal role in strengthening the University's academic and technological infrastructure.

Through his dedication and passion, Professor Singla established a strong presence in academia. His extensive teaching experience, research initiatives, academic publications, collaborative projects, and commitment to student mentorship reflect a career devoted to excellence and continuous learning. Known for his humility, grounded nature, and deep respect for colleagues and students alike, he inspired generations not only through knowledge but through character.

The retirement function was conducted on 9th January 2026 in UCIL Seminar Hall in the presence of faculty members, staff, colleagues, former associates, and family members of Professor Singla. The ceremony featured heartfelt addresses by Dr. Anuj Sharma, Chairperson, DCSA; Professor Sonal Chawla, Director, Dr. A. P. J. Abdul Kalam Computer Center; Professor Sukhwinder Singh, Director, UIET; Professor Indu Chhabra; and Professor Anu Gupta. Each speaker reflected on Professor Singla's academic excellence, visionary leadership, humility, and collaborative spirit. Members of the faculty and staff also shared fond memories and personal reflections, highlighting his mentorship, calm demeanor, sportsmanship, and unwavering belief in continuous learning.

In his address, Professor Singla expressed his heartfelt gratitude to the University community for their support, collaboration, and shared journey over the years. Reflecting on his decades of service, he fondly recalled the growth of the department and emphasized his enduring belief in continuous learning, adaptability, and intellectual curiosity; the values that he has consistently embodied throughout his career.

The ceremony concluded with the presentation of tokens of appreciation by the Chairperson, faculty, and staff of DCSA, along with members of the Dr. A. P. J. Abdul Kalam Computer Center, as a mark of gratitude and respect for his invaluable contributions to the department and the University.

Professor R. K. Singla's retirement marks the culmination of a notable chapter in the history of DCSA. His journey reminds us that academic excellence is not defined solely by positions held or milestones achieved, but by integrity upheld, humility practiced, a lifelong commitment to learning, and the countless lives touched along the way. Beyond his academic and administrative accomplishments, Professor Singla will be remembered for his warmth, sportsmanship, and calm, thoughtful presence. His influence continues to inspire, guiding us beyond classrooms and corridors. It is, indeed, a legacy that lives on.

The DCSA family extends its heartfelt gratitude and conveys its warmest wishes for his continued health, happiness, and fulfillment in the years ahead.

- Vaishali Mehta



Career Catalyst: Mastering Soft Skills for the Modern Workplace







The 30-hour Value Added Course (VAC) titled "Career Catalyst: Mastering Soft Skills for the Modern Workplace" was organized by the Central Placement Cell, Panjab University, from January 19 to February 3, 2026, with the objective of enhancing students' employability skills and bridging the gap between academic knowledge and industry expectations. Conducted under the guidance of Prof. Meena Sharma along with Dr. Ravneet Kaur, Dr. Rohini Sharma, and Prof. Sarabjeet Singh, the programme witnessed active participation from postgraduate students across various departments, promoting interdisciplinary learning and holistic development. The sessions were systematically scheduled six days a week, ensuring continuity and effective engagement through structured modules that covered all essential aspects of professional readiness.

The programme commenced with Module 1 on Foundations of Professionalism, where Mr. Vivek Atrey emphasized the importance of ethical conduct, discipline, and professional habits in shaping one's career. He further introduced SWOT analysis as a tool for self-assessment, enabling students to align their strengths and weaknesses with career opportunities. This laid a strong foundation for subsequent modules. Module 2 focused extensively on Effective Communication Skills, where Mr. Anish Dua highlighted verbal communication techniques and the significance of active listening, while also explaining the impact of non-verbal cues such as body language and gestures. Dr. Manvinder expanded on team management and communication by discussing teamwork, leadership, conflict resolution, and collaboration strategies. Additionally, Dr. Anuradha Thakur trained students in written communication, particularly professional email etiquette, and guided them through online job portals and application procedures, making the learning highly practical and relevant.

Module 3 on Interview Preparation and Techniques, conducted by Ms. Sakshi, equipped students with strategies to handle different types of interviews and effectively answer common questions.

This was further strengthened by Dr. Vidhi Miglani's sessions on behavioral interviews and the STAR technique, along with best practices for video interviews. Module 4, led by Mr. Sahil Arora, focused on resume building, where students learned to structure and tailor resumes according to industry requirements and participated in a hands-on workshop for practical exposure. The programme then progressed to Module 5 on Business Networking, where Dr. Tejinder Pal Singh introduced LinkedIn as a personal branding tool and provided hands-on training in digital networking, emphasizing the importance of a strong online professional presence.

Module 6 addressed Stress Management and Conflict Resolution, with Dr. Manvinder and Dr. Amandeep Kahlon guiding students on managing workplace stress, practicing mindfulness, building resilience, and resolving conflicts effectively. This was followed by Module 7 on Presentation and Public Speaking by Mr. Sanjeev Sharma, where students learned to overcome stage fear, deliver impactful presentations, and engage audiences both physically and virtually. Module 8 served as the culmination of practical training through mock group discussions and personal interviews conducted by Dr. Sanjeev Gupta and Mr. Amrit Lal. These sessions provided real-time exposure to recruitment processes and enabled students to apply their learning in simulated environments while receiving constructive feedback to improve performance.

The final modules further strengthened professional readiness. Module 9, led by Mr. Anish Dua, focused on time management and organizational skills, teaching students to prioritize tasks, manage deadlines, and maintain productivity through organized workspaces. Module 10, conducted by Dr. Pradeep Khanna, provided valuable industry insights and career guidance, helping students understand current trends and explore suitable career paths. A key feature of the programme was the continuity maintained through brief reviews at the beginning of each session, which reinforced learning, clarified doubts, and connected new concepts with previous knowledge, thereby enhancing overall comprehension and engagement.
The course also incorporated valuable insights from experienced resource persons, emphasizing that professionalism is a daily habit, communication is defined by listening, and confidence grows through preparation and practice. Participants expressed appreciation for the practical orientation and relevance of the course content.

Jasneet Kaur (MCA-I [M]) shared, "The course significantly enhanced my confidence and communication skills. I found the sessions on professionalism, resume building, and mock interviews particularly helpful in understanding real-world placement expectations."
Ronak Sood (MCA-I [E]) remarked, "The structured modules and interactive approach made the learning experience highly engaging. I especially appreciated the mock GD and PI sessions, which provided valuable exposure to actual recruitment scenarios."
Diksha (UIAMS, MBA) stated, "The course offered a comprehensive understanding of soft skills essential for corporate readiness.

The sessions on presentation skills, stress management, and LinkedIn networking were especially beneficial for my professional growth."

At the successful completion of the course, students were awarded certificates of active participation, recognizing their dedication and consistent involvement. Dr. Anuj Sharma congratulated all participants and commended their efforts in actively engaging with every session. Overall, the Value Added Course proved to be a comprehensive and impactful learning experience, combining theoretical knowledge with practical application, and effectively equipping students with essential soft skills required for professional success and workplace readiness.

- Diya Ahuja MCA-I(M)

AI: Necessity or Future Threat? — A debate by M.Sc. (Hons) C.S. 1st Year (Data Science)





The M.Sc. (Hons) C.S. 1st Year (Specialisation in Data Science) class organized an internal debate on February 4, 2026 on the compelling topic, "AI: Necessity of the Present or Threat of the Future." The class was divided into two teams of nine members each, speaking for and against the motion.

Each participant presented well-structured arguments supported by relevant statistics and research. The team speaking in favour of AI as a necessity—comprising Vikram, Sachin, Mahesh, Satvik, Balpreet, Jasleen, Rahul, Monika, and Dilshaan highlighted the transformative role of AI across sectors such as manufacturing, healthcare, agriculture, national security, and everyday life.

On the other hand, the opposing team Shivam, Jigyasa, May Thazin, Mehak, Sneha, Rimzhim, Drishti, Akriti, and Ishita presented strong counter arguments. They raised concerns regarding climate degradation, malpractice, overdependence on AI, reduced creativity among youth, and the risks of misleading mental and medical advice. Both sides concluded their speeches with clarity and conviction, making the debate engaging and intellectually stimulating. Overall, the discussion was strongly influenced by the team advocating AI as a necessity in today's world making them the winner of the debate. The debate was organized under the guidance of Dr. Kavita Taneja and was coordinated by Rishabh Bhatia of MSc 1st year.

- Rishabh Bhatia MSC-I

Building Confidence & Character: A Workshop with Mr. Shivinder Mandhotra



On February 6, 2026, a personality development workshop was conducted from 11:15 AM to 1:00 PM. The session was led by Mr. Shivinder Mandhotra, a Corporate and PoSH Trainer as well as an Executive Coach. The workshop was organized under the guidance of Dr. Anuj Sharma, Chairperson of the department, along with Dr. Anuj Kumar and Dr. Kavita Taneja, Training and Placement Officers. The coordination of the event was carried out by the TPC members, with special efforts from Mr. Kuldeep Singh, Chief Placement Coordinator, Arin Devyaal and Diya Ahuja, TPC Co-Coordinators.

The dais was handled by the hosts Kritika, MCA-I(E) and Ronak Sood MCA-I(E) and active members of the TPC communication team, who ensured the smooth flow of the program. The guest speaker was warmly escorted to the venue by Mr. Ramashish Kondal, Ph.D. scholar in the department, which added a formal touch to the proceedings.

Mr. Shivinder Mandhotra began the workshop by explaining the difference between personality and persona. He highlighted that personality is how we appear to others, while persona reflects our internal values. He emphasized that character is built on qualities such as integrity, honesty, discipline, mindset, ownership, empathy, and emotional intelligence.



He explained that these values form the foundation of both personal and professional success. He also shared insights from research on successful individuals and their journeys, which revealed that soft skills, negotiation abilities, leadership qualities, and the ability to influence others contribute nearly 85% to success in interviews, while hard skills and domain knowledge account for only 15%. He stressed that high IQ alone does not guarantee growth, but high emotional intelligence (EQ) plays a crucial role in building strong organizations and relationships.

The speaker then discussed the qualities required for career success. He explained the importance of mindset, both conscious and subconscious, and illustrated this with the inspiring example of Arunima Sinha, who achieved remarkable success despite great challenges. Arunima Sinha is an Indian mountaineer and sportsperson. She is India's first amputee and the world's first female amputee to climb Mount Everest. Her story shows how strong determination can overcome difficulties. The speaker also underlined the need for planning and execution, stating that success requires not just ideas but consistent action.

Ownership was another key quality he emphasized, urging students to treat the company's work and growth as their responsibility. Mr. Shivinder Mandhotra also spoke about professional behavior and communication. He advised students to be assertive rather than aggressive, to respond thoughtfully instead of reacting impulsively, and to communicate effectively with open body language. Grooming and presentation, he said, are equally important, as the first impression often creates a lasting impression.

The workshop concluded with a strong message that personality development is not limited to external appearance but is deeply rooted in internal values and emotional intelligence. The organizers honored Mr. Shivinder Mandhotra with a memento at the end of the session as a token of appreciation. The event was highly engaging and provided practical guidance for students preparing for placements and future professional opportunities.

– Girija Sharma MCA-I(M)

Algo Arena – A Confluence of Creativity and Technology





The IT Fest Algo Arena was held on February 25, 2026, with enthusiastic participation from students across various colleges. A total of 167 participants joined the event, making it a grand success. The fest was coordinated by Dr. Jasleen Kaur Bains and Dr. Rohini Sharma. The registration process commenced at 9:00 a.m. sharp in the lawn outside the department, where participants were provided with ID cards and refreshment coupons at the registration desk. The registration of participants was efficiently managed by members of the IT Club, the Cultural Club, and dedicated volunteers, including Arnav Khantwal (MCA-M), Jigyasa (M.Sc. Computer Science—Specialization in Data Science), Aditi (MCA-E), Rishabh Bhatia (M.Sc. Computer Science —Specialization in Data Science), Diya Ahuja (MCA-M), Charandeep Singh (MCA-M), and Bhavya (MCA-E).

Following registration, participants were guided to Room No. 317, where the inaugural session was scheduled. The session began at 10:00 a.m. and lasted for about 20 minutes. It commenced with the lamp-lighting ceremony by esteemed Dr. Anuj Sharma and esteemed faculty members. After the ceremonial lighting, the faculty members delivered inspiring speeches, warmly welcoming the participants and encouraging them to actively engage in the fest.

The inaugural session was gracefully hosted by Ridhi Sharma (MCA-M) and Mehak (M.Sc. Computer Science – Specialization in Data Science), who ensured the smooth flow of the program and set a positive tone for the events to follow.
After the inaugural session, the participants were guided to their respective venues by the volunteers. From 10:30 a.m. onwards, the events of the fest began simultaneously across different rooms and laboratories.

The Logo Design Competition was conducted in Lab 1 from 10:30 a.m. to 12:00 p.m., judged by Prof. R. K. Singla and Dr. Balwinder Kaur. The event was coordinated by Anuj , Raunak & Amit Rawat along with Manasvi Sharma acting as a volunteer.

The competition was an individual event lasting 90 minutes. Participants were required to design logos during the event itself using Inkscape. The use of AI-based logo generators was prohibited, while limited internet access was permitted for reference. The evaluation criteria included design accuracy and precision, typography, color harmony, and creativity in redesign. The winners were First Prize – GGDSD College, Second Prize – DCSA, Panjab University, and Third Prize – PGGC, Sector 46.



The Vibe Coding (Web Development), was conducted in the RUSA Lab from 10:30 a.m. to 12:30 p.m. under the adjudication of Prof. (Dr.) Indu Chhabra and Mrs. Kamakshi Pundhir. The event allowed teams of two participants, encouraging collaboration and creative problem-solving. The competition was coordinated by Faiz and Karan along with volunteers Amanpreet, and Jasleen Kaur.

Participants were given 120 minutes to design a frontend web interface, while the use of backend technologies and APIs was strictly prohibited. AI tools were permitted to support development. The event focused on testing participants' ability to create visually appealing and modern web interfaces within a limited time frame.

The judging criteria included visual aesthetics, modern design appeal, creativity, and originality. The winners were First Prize – PGGGC, Sector 11, Second Prize – GGDSD College, Sector 32, and Third Prize – DCSA, Panjab University.



In the DCSA Corridor, the Rangoli Competition was conducted from 11:00 a.m. to 1:00 p.m., judged by Prof. (Dr.) Sonal Chawla. The event was coordinated by Sneha and Ishita, along with Jigyasa acting as the volunteer.

The theme of the competition was "Technology Meets Tradition." Each team consisted of two participants, and they were given 90 minutes to complete their rangoli designs. Participants creatively combined traditional rangoli patterns with modern technological elements such as circuits, robots, and AI symbols, making the corridor vibrant and artistic. The winners were First Prize - PGGCG Sector 42 , Second Prize - DAV College , Sector 10 , and Third Prize - Dev Samaj College.



The Startup Pitching (Presentations) was conducted in Room No. 316 from 10:30 a.m. to 12:00 p.m. The competition was adjudicated by Prof. (Dr.) Anu Gupta and Dr. Kavita Taneja. A total of nine teams participated in the event, each comprising two members from the same college, along with one team representing our department. The event was coordinated by Shashwat Sharma and Prachi, along with volunteer Suraj.

The event simulated a real-world startup pitching environment, encouraging students to present innovative and entrepreneurial ideas. Each team was allotted ten minutes to present their startup-style pitch deck proposing an original SaaS product idea. Although coding was not mandatory, the use of AI tools was permitted with proper disclosure.

The judging criteria included problem understanding, innovation, technical feasibility, business model scalability, pitch clarity, storytelling, and handling of the Q&A session. After evaluation, the winners were declared: First Prize – MCM DAV College, Second Prize – DAV College, Sector 10, and Third Prize – DCSA, Panjab University.







The Debate Competition was conducted in Room No. 315 from 10:30 a.m. to 12:00 p.m., judged by Dr. Jasleen Kaur Bains and coordinated by Kritika and Aditi, along with Shivam acting as a volunteer.



Participants debated topics such as "AI has made humans lazy" and "Ethics in Innovation." Each participant was given two minutes to present arguments strictly for or against the motion. The use of notes, mobile phones, or smart devices was not permitted, ensuring reliance on participants' knowledge and articulation skills.

The judging criteria included content quality, relevance, clarity, confidence, rebuttal effectiveness, and overall presentation. The winners were First Prize – MCM DAV College, Second Prize – PGGGC, Sector 11, and Third Prize – BBA Department, Panjab University.



The Debugging Contest was conducted in Lab 2 from 10:30 a.m. to 12:30 p.m. under the adjudication of Dr. Sudhir Goyal and Mr. Ujjwal. The event involved teams of two participants and was coordinated by Ratan and Tushar along with volunteers Nimrat Kaur and Vanshika.

The competition consisted of multiple rounds designed to test participants' ability to identify and correct coding errors. Internet access was strictly prohibited, ensuring participants to rely solely on their programming knowledge.

The evaluation focused on correct debugging solutions and code accuracy. The winners were : First Prize – GCCBA, Sector 50, Second Prize – GGDSD College, Sector 32, and Third Prize – DCSA, Panjab University.









The IT Quiz was held in Room No. 317, with nine teams participating. The event was adjudicated by Mrs. Binh and Mr. Ujjwal and coordinated by Akriti and Monika, along with volunteers Rohit, Bhavya, and Balpreet.
The quiz consisted of three rounds: an MCQ round, a group-based questionnaire round, and a final buzzer round, testing participants' knowledge, analytical thinking, and quick responses.

The winners were : First Prize – DCSA, Panjab University, Second Prize – MCM DAV College, and Third Prize – DAV College, Sector 10.

The Mobile Video Advertisement Shoot and Edit event was conducted from 10:30 a.m. to 1:00 p.m., judged by our alumni Mr. Prabhjeet Garcha, a Film Director and coordinated by Vishal and Charandeep.



Participants were required to conceptualize, shoot, and edit a short advertisement video within the Panjab University campus. Videos could include music, acting, and dancing, allowing participants to creatively convey their product idea.

The judging criteria included creativity, originality, storytelling, and overall flow of the video. The winners were First Prize – MCM DAV College, Second Prize – DAV College, Sector 10, and Third Prize – GGSCW (Girls College).



The Poster Making Competition was conducted in Swayam Lab 1 from 11:00 a.m. to 1:00 p.m., judged by Dr. Anuj Kumar and coordinated by Ridhi Sharma and Sanjam alongwith Banita acting as the volunteer.

The theme "AI: Friend or Threat" encouraged participants to visually represent the impact of artificial intelligence on society. Posters had to be created on A3 sheets, and printed or pre-planned material was not permitted.

The winners were First Prize – DAV College, Sector 10, Second Prize – DCSA, Panjab University, and Third Prize – PGGGC, Sector 11.



The Mobile Gaming Competition (Clash Royale) was conducted in Lab 3 from 11:00 a.m. to 12:30 p.m. and attracted significant attention from participants and spectators. The event was coordinated by Vishal and Rajat.

The competition followed a knockout format, where players competed in Draft Battles to ensure fairness.

The winners were First Prize – DCSA, Panjab University, Second Prize – CDOE, Panjab University, and Third Prize – GCCBA, Sector 50.

The innovative event Prompt Engineering was conducted in PC Lab–II at 1:00 p.m., judged by Dr. Kavita Taneja and Mrs. Kamakshi Pundir. The event was coordinated by Satvik Chandel, and the volunteers for this event were Amit Rawat and Diya , with 11 teams participating.



Participants were required to generate AI images using Gemini that closely resembled the given reference images. Prompts were limited to 250 characters, with three attempts per round within 10 minutes.

The winners were First Prize – MCM DAV College, Second Prize – DCSA, Panjab University, and Third Prize – GGSCW (Girls College).







The Prize Distribution Ceremony began at 2:30 p.m. in Room No. 317 in the presence of Dr. Anuj Sharma, Prof. (Dr.) Sonal Chawla, Dr. Jasleen Kaur Bains, Dr. Anuj Kumar and Mrs. Binh. The ceremony was hosted by Ridhi Sharma and Mehak.

Winning teams were awarded prizes and certificates, recognizing their excellence, creativity, and technical proficiency across various competitions of the fest. Dr. Anuj Sharma, Chairperson of the Department, congratulated all participants and appreciated their enthusiasm and innovative spirit. Based on the cumulative performance across various competitions, the Overall Trophy of Algo Arena 2026 was proudly lifted by MCM DAV College.

Overall, Algo Arena 2026 was a lively and successful event that encouraged innovation, creativity, technical skills, and teamwork among students from different colleges. Its success came from the efforts of faculty coordinators Dr. Jasleen Kaur Bains and Dr. Rohini Sharma along with the student team members — Ratan Gulati, Mahesh Chandra, and Arnav Khantwal managed the database; Arnav, Vishal, Aditi, Anuj, and Diya handled the designs; Sachin looked after food and hospitality; Sanjam managed finances; and outreach was done by Arnav, Rishab, Ridhi, Monika, Sanjam, Mehak, and others. Certificate printing and banners were managed by Mahesh Chandra, Rishabh Bhatia, and Arnav Khantwal, while Vishal created social media content. Report coverage was prepared by Girija Sharma, Anjali Sharma, and Aayush Gupta.





Together, these efforts made Algo Arena 2026 not just an event, but a memorable celebration of teamwork and talent.

-Editorial Team



